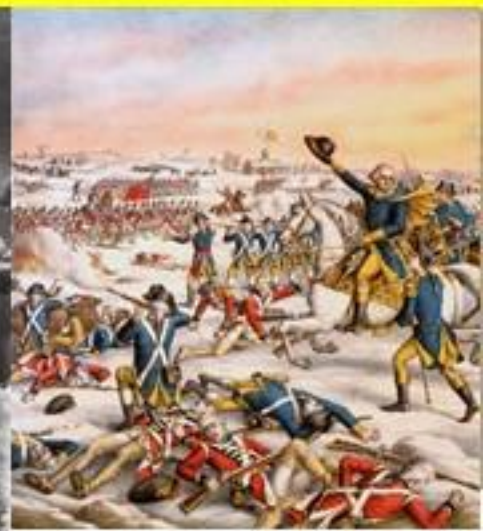


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 8

COUNTER-REFORMATION

COUNTER-REFORMATION

- The success of the Reformation movement created a great awe and fear in the Roman Catholic Church.
- Before things went out of control, it took drastic measures to check the spread of the Protestant religion and also to carry out reforms within itself.
- This process was known as Counter-Reformation.



COUNTER-REFORMATION

IGNATIUS LOYOLA

- Ignatius Loyola (1491-1556) was a Spanish soldier and lost his legs in a war.
- Thereafter, he decided to contribute his might to the cause of the Roman Catholic Church.
- Loyola founded the Society of Jesus in 1534 and it was recognized by the Pope.
- The aim of this Society was to reform and restore the glory of the Catholic Church.
- Members of the society were known as Jesuits.
- They worked hard to earn good name for the Catholic Church through their dedicated service.
- They established schools and colleges in several parts of the world.
- They achieved a remarkable success in their missionary activities.
- They remained faithful to the Pope and the Catholic religion.



COUNTER-REFORMATION

COUNCIL OF TRENT

The Council of Trent (1545-1563) introduced several reforms in the Catholic Church:

- The most glaring abuses of the clergy were removed.
- Celibacy was strictly enforced for them.
- The sale of offices was stopped.
- The practice of the sale of indulgences was abolished.
- It also stressed that clergy adhere more strictly to their duties.
- The Pope was recognized as the supreme authority in the matters of religion.



COUNTER-REFORMATION

- An Index consisting of the list of dangerous and heretical books was issued by the Church. The Catholics were prohibited from reading these books.
- Similarly the medieval practice of Ecclesiastical Court of Inquisition was revived.
- Torture was used to extract confession.
- Severe punishments such as burning to death were employed against the enemies of the Church.
- The success of the Counter Reformation can be understood from the fact that the rapid spread of Protestantism was halted.
- Southern Germany, France, Poland, some of the Swiss cantons, and Savoy were brought back to the Catholic faith.
- At the same time Protestantism was driven out of Italy and Spain.
- The Roman Catholic Church is still one of the greatest religious organizations in the world.



WHAT ARE THE RESULTS OF REFORMATION?

SCHISM IN CHRISTIANITY

- The Reformation led to two major divisions in Christianity – Catholics and Protestants.
- This division had resulted in religious persecution and religious wars in Germany and in other parts of Europe.



INTERPRETATION OF BIBLE

- People were encouraged to read the Bible and ponder on religion.
- The freedom given by the Protestants to interpret the Bible led to free thinking.
- It encouraged the development of art, literature and science.



WHAT ARE THE RESULTS OF REFORMATION?

NATIONALISTIC CHURCHES

- The democratic church system paved the way for the growth of democracy and nationalism.
- The nations began to evolve their own churches.
- The place of Pope was taken by the nationalistic churches.



PURIFICATION OF CHURCH

- The rapid progress of the Protestant religion and the counter-Reformation ultimately resulted in the purification of the Church.
- Both Catholics and Protestants began to adopt high moral standards after the Reformation.
- The Catholics purified their Church establishments and this in turn improved the values in the society.



SEQUENCE OF EVENTS

16th century	Religious Reformation in Europe
Protest against Christian Church	Emergence of Protestant Christian religion
The Pope and the clergy - luxurious lives	That undermined the respect and prestige of the Church.
Renaissance movement	Spirit of inquiry among the masses
John Wycliffe	Morning Star of the Reformation
Erasmus	In Praise of Folly
Nation-states	Eroded the political influence enjoyed by the Church
Martin Luther	Systematic campaign for the removal of evils of the Church.
Protestants	German princes drew up a protest against Charles V decision
Peace of Augsburg	Princes either to remain Catholic or Lutheran
Ulrich Zwingli	Attacked abuses of the Church such as the sale of indulgences

SEQUENCE OF EVENTS

Contd ...

John Calvin	His main teachings- Bible alone is the final authority. His religious sect was own as Calvinism.
King Henry VIII of England	Act of Supremacy- king -the head of the Church of England- Anglican Church
Counter-Reformation	To check the spread of the Protestant religion -reforms within itself.
Ignatius Loyola	Society of Jesus- reform and restore the glory of the Catholic Church- Jesuits.
The Council of Trent	Pope -Supreme authority in the matters of religion.
Schism in Christianity	Catholics and Protestants- resulted in religious persecution and religious wars
Interpretation the Bible	led to free thinking- encouraged- development of art, literature and science
The democratic church system	Growth of democracy and nationalism
Purification of the Church	Rapid progress of the Protestant religion and the Counter-Reformation

WORLD HISTORY

TIMELINE OF EVENTS

DATE	EVENTS
1492	Columbus claims Bahama Islands and Cuba for Spain
1517	Martin Luther writes the Ninety-Five Theses
1522	Luther translates the Bible into German
1525	Peasant uprising in Germany
1559	Anglican Church established in England, with the king/queen as its head

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